Increasing year-round engagement for students and early professionals on LinkedIn



Product Overview

Founded in 2003 by Reid Hoffman · Acquired by Microsoft in 2016 for $26.2B · World's largest professional network operating in 200+ countries

Professional Marketing | **Job Marketplace** | **B2B Advertising** | **Learning (LinkedIn Learning)**

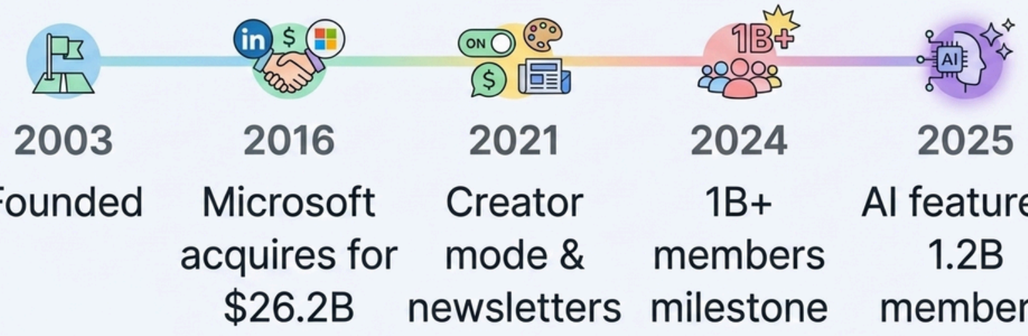
1.2B+
Registered users

310M
Monthly Active Users

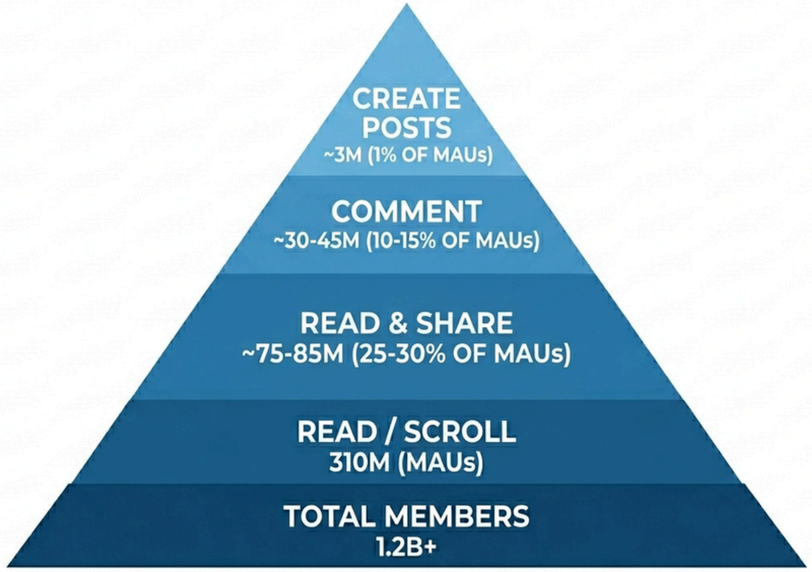
$17.8B
Revenue FY25

200+
Countries & territories

PLATFORM MILESTONES



Only 1% of monthly users post weekly — yet those users generate 9B impressions



LinkedIn's Engagement Funnel

Competitve Landscape

	LinkedIn	Instagram	Snapchat	Gaps & Insights
Primary Purpose	Networking/Job Hunting	Entertainment	Entertainment, Chat	LinkedIn has no clear purpose once job is secured, i.e., identity gap
Usage frequency (DAU/MAU)	~43% (134.5M DAU / 310M MAU)	~65% (500M DAU / 3B MAU)	~53% (453M DAU / 850M MAU)	LinkedIn is treated as a utility, not a habit
Avg. Session Duration	~7 min per visit (Similarweb)	~33 min per day (Meta data)	~30 min per day (Snap Inc.)	LinkedIn sessions are transactional, not exploratory, i.e., users complete a task and leave.
%users creating posts	~1% post weekly	~20-30%	~50%+	LinkedIn triggers anxiety, not enjoyment due to humblebragging
Engagement Style	Passive scrolling	Active liking / sharing	Direct messaging	LinkedIn lacks engagement loops that drive daily return behaviour

User Research & Validation

9 users were interviewed

7/9 users mentions reduced usage after getting offer

4/9 users mentions LinkedIn feels more about showcasing success

2/9 users found LinkedIn meaningful for building long-term professional value

6/9 users feels LinkedIn feed contains self-promotion instead of useful content

I thought about posting, I had hibernated my profile for close to a year and removed some posts and comments so I started again fresh but I see so many cringe AI posts and honestly don't feel like sharing anything.

-Mudit, 22, Analyst

My LinkedIn usage dropped to near zero the second I signed my offer letter. Before placement, I was on it for hours everyday, sending cold messages, and doom-scrolling through my peer's achievements. It felt like a toxic comparison trap that completely drained my energy.

-Ridhima, 22, BA

I always thought I didn't have anything 'big enough' to post, and I kept telling myself I'd do it once I had more time to make the post look better. Eventually, that thought kept getting postponed, and LinkedIn just slipped out of my routine.

-Thejhas, 21, Student

I use LinkedIn to look for jobs. While I am happily employed, I use it to maintain my network and keep an eye out for better opportunities. Apart from that it isn't useful to. It is useful as a tool, don't feel the need to read it all the time

-Khushal, 24, SDE



It started as a job platform but now it feels like a content farm where everyone's personal brand is "grateful, grinding and excited to announce".



I just use it as a resume hosting medium and switch to hibernate when I'm not searching. It's really just good for showing an employer that looks you up that you're a real person.

User Persona



Atishya Jain
Age: 23
Tier2/3 College pass-out student
Product Analyst at a startup

Analytics | Tech Trends | Product Management

Psychographics

Lifestyle:

- Full-time early-career professional
- Consumes digital content YouTube, newsletters, podcasts during breaks.
- Follows tech and product communities online for learning and inspiration
- Balances startup hustle with personal growth and career visibility goals

Digital Habits

- Checks Slack, emails, and work tools daily
- Active on Instagram, YouTube, and WhatsApp
- Uses social media primarily for entertainment and learning

Goals:

- Understand how his current role connects to where he wants to go next — tracking industry direction and adjacent roles.
- Expand a meaningful professional network (peers, alumni, mentors, recruiters)
- Stay visible to recruiters (maintain an active, updated presence)
- Track and showcase career progress (projects, certifications, achievements)



Engagment on LinkedIn

Pain Points:

- Found no real value using it, other than job hunting or cold mailing recruiters.
- The feed is increasingly filled with AI-generated posts in identical formats — trust in content has eroded, making it harder to find genuinely useful material to learn from.
- Sharing over LinkedIn feels awkward - having nothing impressive to share.

User Persona



Yukti Dahiya
Age: 24
Tier 1 College pass-out student
Software Engineer at a MNC

Gen AI | Tech Podcasts | Content Creation

Psychographics

Lifestyle:

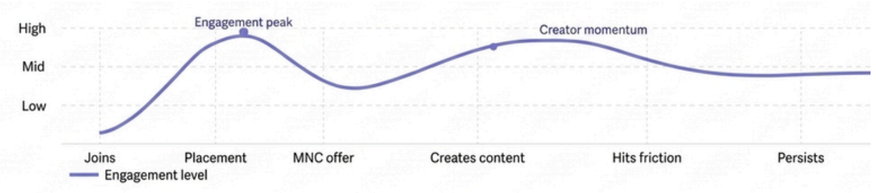
- Full-time early-career professional
- Splits time between deep technical work and upskilling in GenAI
- Driven by social mission — actively pushes for diversity in tech spaces
- Balances professional ambition with giving back to peers and juniors

Digital Habits

- Uses LinkedIn for knowledge-sharing, not just career showcase
- Engagement spikes at milestones, drops during routine phases
- Active on Instagram ,snapchat and you tube for entertainment purpose.

Goals:

- Reach early-career engineers with content that's genuinely useful, not just well-formatted.
- Build domain credibility so opportunities come inbound rather than through cold outreach.
- Help more women and minorities enter tech.
- Identify mentees who would benefit from her experience without waiting for cold messages.



Engagment on LinkedIn

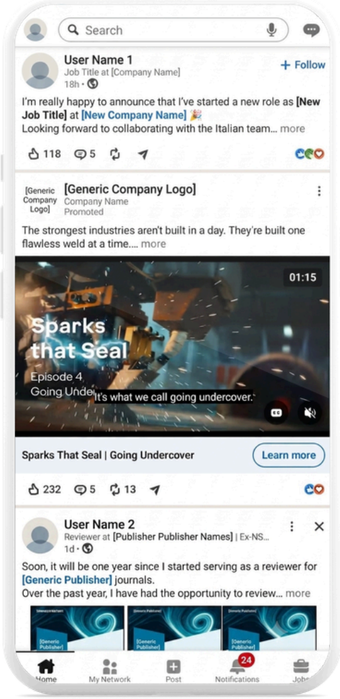
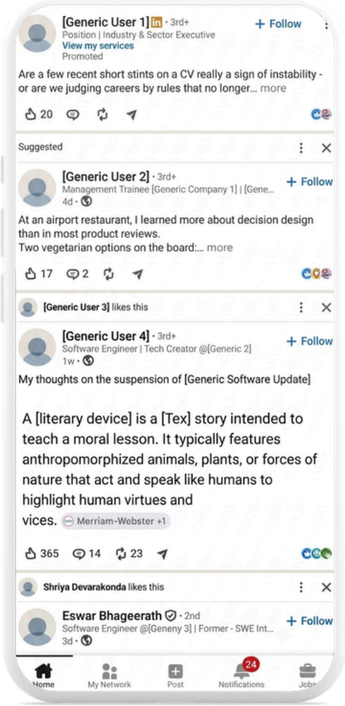
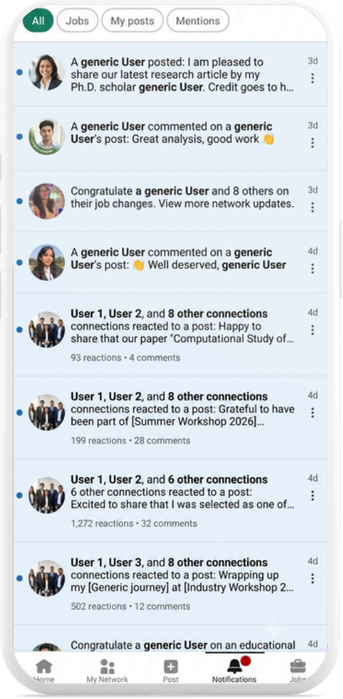
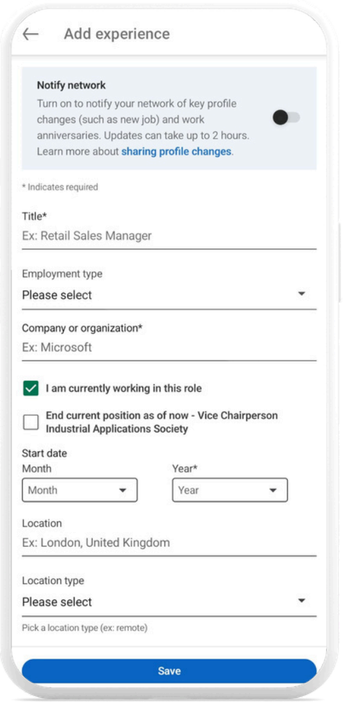
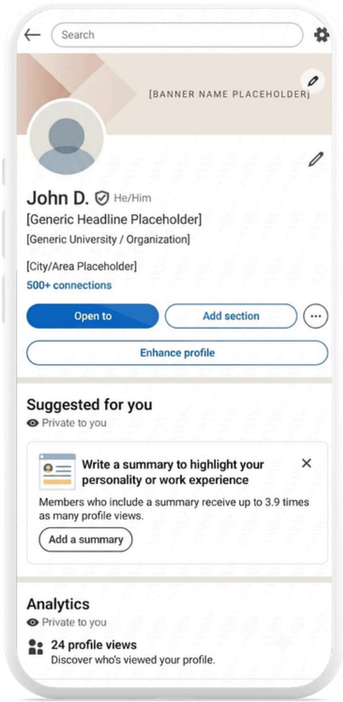
Pain Points:

- Algorithm pushes achievement/buzz content over useful technical content
- Re-engagement friction too high after short periods of inactivity
- Notifications flooded with work anniversaries and job changes — genuine comments get buried

User Journey Mapping



Focusing on Atishya's Journey

User Steps	Intent	Passive Consumption	Active filtering	Notification noise	High-friction action	Session exit
Reference Screens						
User Action	Opens Linkedin for updating his profile.	Feed opens, filled with announcement and achievements.	Scrolls, find irrelevant posts filled with AI generated content	Checks notifications, find irrelevant updates.	Adds experience, but turned off notification to connections	Updated the profile and closes the app
Fellings / Thoughts	Atishya wants to update his current job profile.	He feels intimidated by the achievements on his feed.	Scrolls, find irrelevant posts filled with AI generated content	Frustrated by irrelevant notifications, he wants updates, not distant anniversaries.	Atishya fears network judgment and imposter syndrome, thus hides his profile update	Leaves the platform feeling anxious and disconnected.
Emotions	😊 Motivated	😐 Disengaged	😟 Bored	😔 Indifferent	😶‍🌫️ Hesitant	😶 Detached

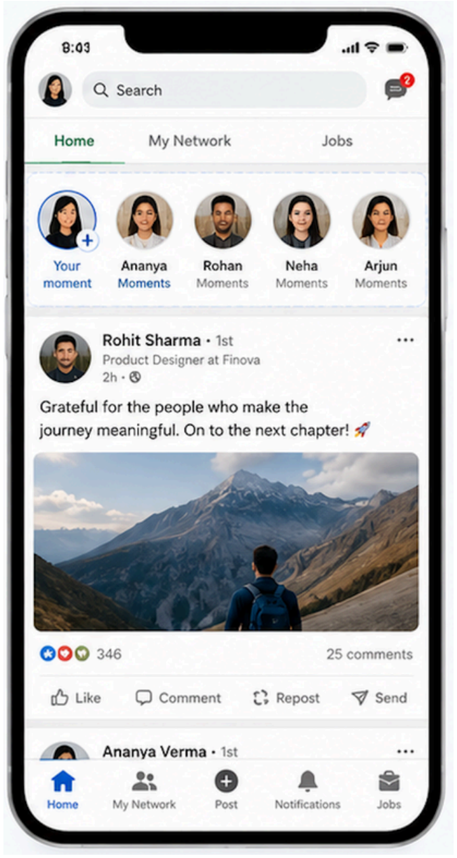
Prioritization

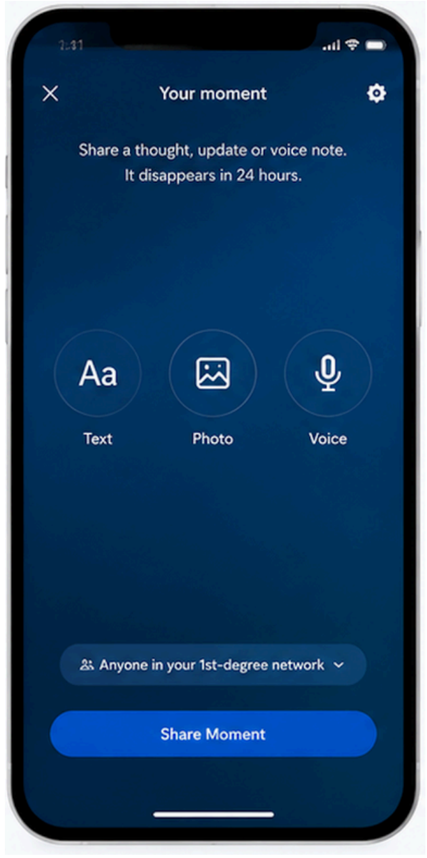
PAIN POINTS	REACH (/10)	IMPACT (/10)	SCORE (Reach*Impact)
Achievement posts get more visibility than useful content	9	7	63
Notifications flooded with work anniversaries and job changes, updates get buried	8	6	48
AI-generated content has eroded trust in the feed	7	8	54
Sharing feels forced due to pressure to post something "impressive."	9	9	81

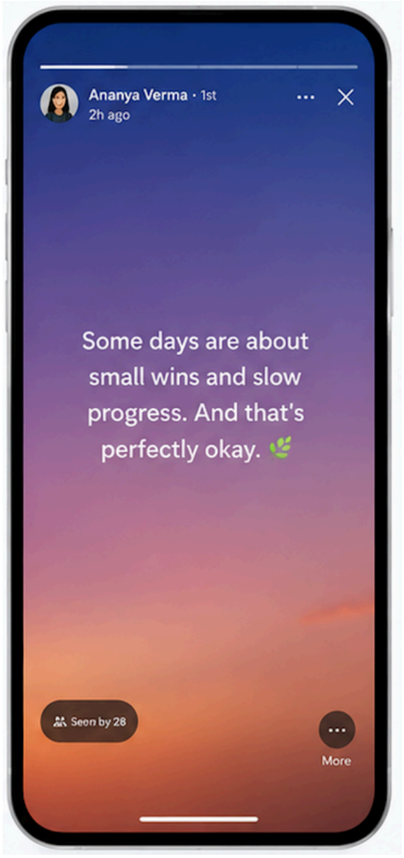
*We’ll be focusing on the pain points with highest score 81 according to the estimation using Reach*Impact scoring derived from the RICE framework.

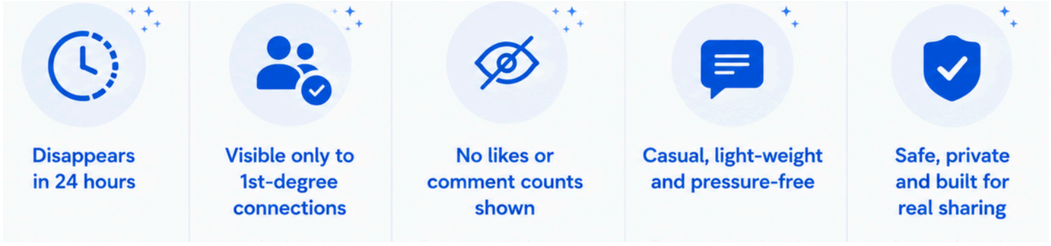
Solution

Introducing LinkedIn Moments









The goal is to make it easier for Atishya to overcome the performance anxiety loop and share casual updates. It directly addresses the "blank composer" problem by providing a 24-hour disappearing format, allowing users to share insights freely without the fear of long-term professional judgment.

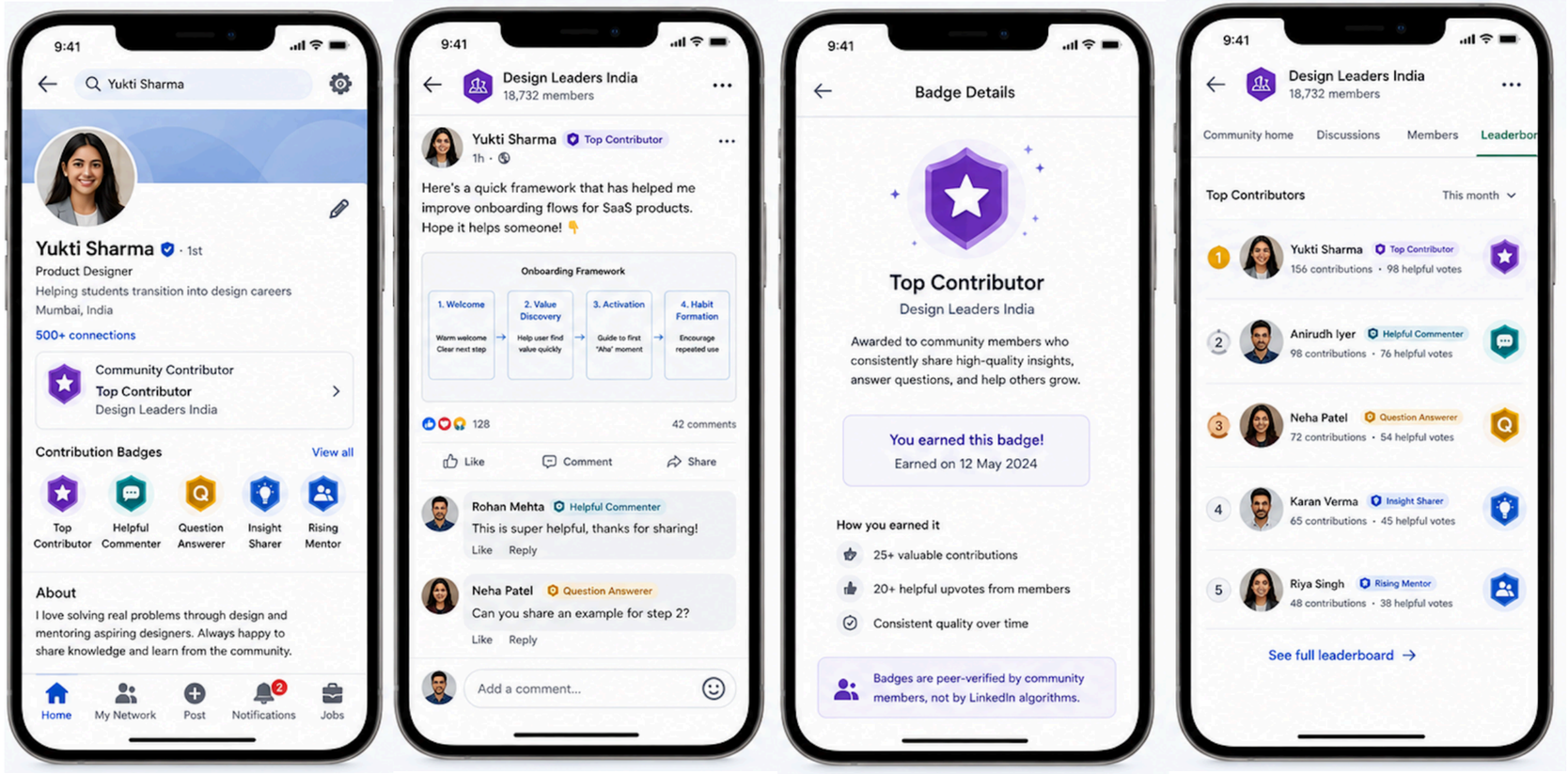
It should essentially remove the psychological barrier of "nothing big enough to post" and transform LinkedIn into a low-friction, go-to space for organic sharing. By shifting casual daily updates into an ephemeral tray, it actively decreases less relevant content—like repetitive milestone journey posts—and keeps the main feed reserved for high-value networking.

Solution

Introducing Community Badges

Designed to supercharge user engagement by rewarding meaningful contributions, addressing the hesitation users feel when consuming content passively by anchoring professional recognition strictly in peer-validated utility, creating a compelling reason for them to shift from scrolling to active, high-value contribution.

It should essentially remove the psychological barrier of "posting into a void" and transform engagement into a highly motivating, friction-free habit loop, turning the platform into a self-sustaining ecosystem where every meaningful interaction builds authentic professional credibility in real time.



How badges are earned?

1. Contribute → 2. Get Verified → 3. Earn Badges → 4. Build Reputation

Metrics

North Star Metric (NSW)

Weekly Active Contributors (WAC)

unique members who create any piece of content (post, comment, Moment, verified answer/badge-contribution) at least once in a week, as a % of WAU.



L1 Metrics

- **Adoption Rate:** % of WAU who create ≥1 Moment/week
- **New-Poster Activation:** % of users with zero posts in last 90 days who create their first Moment

L2 Metrics

- **Creator Repeat Rate:** % of Moment creators who post a 2nd Moment within 7 days
- **Viewer Engagement Rate** % of eligible 1st-degree connections who view a given Moment



L1 Metrics

- **Contribution Rate:** % of community members making a qualifying contribution/week
- **Activation Rate:** % of previously-passive members making a first contribution post-exposure to badges

L2 Metrics

- **Contributor Retention:** % of badge earners who contribute again within 30 days vs. non-badge earners
- **Badge Earn Rate:** % of active contributors earning ≥1 badge/month